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But the thing is, this is not where it ends for Valve and their Linux adventure. Ever since they introduced a gaming mode for the Steam application, they've been aiming to be the de-facto leading provider for living-room entertainment, something that is in the domain of, you guessed it, gaming consoles. So what is the best thing for a company to do when it needs to compete in a market full of proprietary consoles? It kicks off a platform of its own – the Steam Machines.

Steam Machines will be a little different as compared to the run-of-the-mill consoles that you see on the shelves today. First-off, they will not be single manufacturer made devices. Instead, the whole concept is based on a set of recommended hardware configurations that manufacturers can fiddle with and tweak. You're essentially getting a PC into the living room and that PC is now rated on a pre-determined scale. With SteamOS, these Steam Machines are a sort of crossover between HTPCs and gaming consoles, this is a move that if done right, could easily make a huge impact on the entire industry and bridge the divide that currently separates the console and PC master races.

Regular usage

Another point of contention for people who visited Linux-land from their